

What your trades say

Your three one-year trade files, the settings you asked about, and the seven new ideas - tested on real gold data before they were built.

YOUR FILES

2021-22, 2023-24, 2025-26 (CHOCH only)

TEST PERIOD

Feb 27 - May 25 2026 (3 months)

COSTS

0.6 per ounce per round trip (your files)

SIMULATOR

the strategy's logic in Python, real gold 1m data

YOUR SETTINGS

CHOCH only, R 3, pullback 25, buffer 1, risk 50

STRATEGY

SMC_Structure_Strategy_v9.0.txt

Backtests and simulations describe the past. They are not financial advice and do not guarantee future results. Test every change on a demo account first.

SUMMARY

The short answer

What to change first, and why.

1. **Costs are the biggest problem.** In 2021-22 and 2023-24 commission was 85-93% of the loss; before costs those years were almost flat. Check your real FxPro cost and type it exactly.
2. **Switch 'close and reverse' OFF.** 'Opposite signal' exits lost money in all three files (13,754 and 15,192 in 2021-22 and 2023-24), and OFF was clearly better in the test (+1,442 against +789, drawdown 427 against 975).
3. **Skip small stops.** Stops under 4 to 8 in price lost most of the money in 2021-22 and 2023-24. A minimum stop of 6 helped in the test too.
4. **New York hours were the best** in every file and in the test; 06:00-17:00 the worst.
5. **Of the seven ideas**, the premium / discount filter (with a 50% pullback) helped; liquidity target and partial profit changed little; the higher-timeframe filter, stacking BOS trades and trailing behind every swing lost.
6. **The hedge** (a LONG and a SHORT copy) made about the same as one copy - it is possible, but it did not add profit.

How far to trust it

Your files cover three years but can only answer some questions. The simulator answers all of them, but on three months of data (100 to 270 trades, gold falling). Where both agree - close and reverse OFF, small stops, New York hours - the result is solid. Everything else: backtest it on your chart over a full year before you trade it.

PART 1

Your three trade files

One year (or more) each, as exported from TradingView's List of Trades.

File	Period	Trades	Net	Costs	Before costs	Win	PF	Max DD
2021-22	29 Jan 2021 to 16 Sep 2022	1628	-9,946	9,280	-665	31.0%	0.66	10,190
2023-24	03 Jan 2023 to 20 Feb 2024	1530	-9,932	8,483	-1,448	29.4%	0.63	9,957
2025-26	29 Sep 2025 to 28 Sep 2026	1158	-2,133	2,336	+203	36.6%	0.91	3,650

2021-22 and 2023-24 almost used up the 10,000 account; 2025-26 lost 2,133. In every file the costs are about as large as the whole loss.

How the trades ended

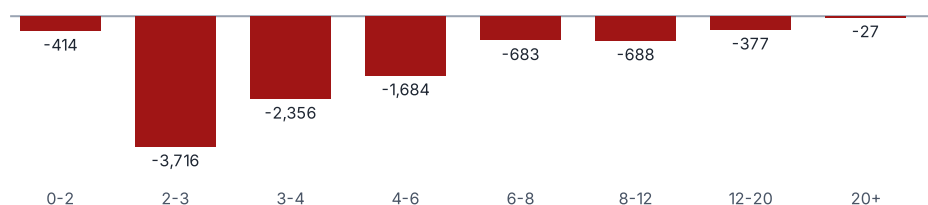
Exit	2021-22 (trades / net)	2023-24	2025-26
Opposite signal	1290 / -13,754	1222 / -15,192	652 / -1,566
Own stop / target	151 / +1,484	156 / +3,472	392 / -2,649
Time flat	136 / +1,831	112 / +1,209	81 / +1,451
Weekend flat	51 / +494	40 / +580	33 / +631

'Opposite signal' - a trade closed by the next CHOCH against it - is where most of the money went in 2021-22 and 2023-24, and it lost in 2025-26 too. Trades held to 02:00 or the weekend made money in every file.

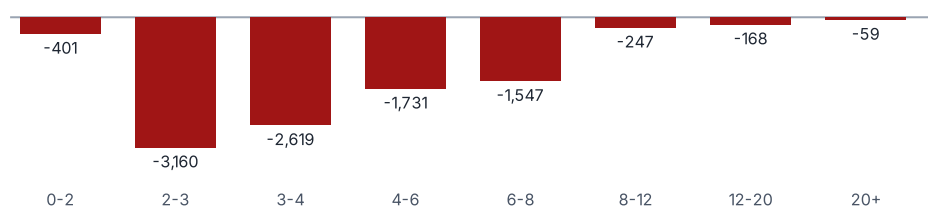
Stop size decides a lot

The stop distance is worked out from the size (risk 50 / size - costs). Small stops mean big sizes, big costs and more noise.

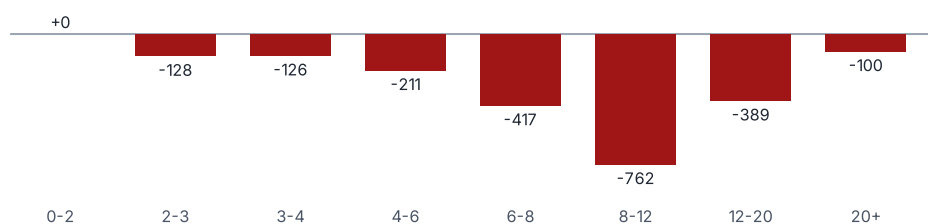
Net by stop distance in price - 2021-22



Net by stop distance in price - 2023-24



Net by stop distance in price - 2025-26



Hours (entry time, your chart's time)

Entries	2021 - 22	2023 - 24	2025 - 26
06-09	259 / -1,045	243 / -2,426	184 / +684
09-12	250 / -2,140	210 / -2,096	196 / -1,365
12-15	327 / -1,383	300 / -1,860	179 / -1,058
15-17	184 / -2,026	150 / -1,013	119 / -270
17-20	416 / -1,932	410 / -1,362	283 / +66
20-23	192 / -1,420	217 / -1,175	197 / -190

What-ifs the files can answer

Removing trades from a file is exact when the strategy holds one trade at a time (CHOC only): the other trades do not change.

What-if	2021 - 22	2023 - 24	2025 - 26
As traded (close and reverse ON, R 3)	-9,946	-9,932	-2,133
Target R 2	-10,099	-10,963	-2,516
Target R 1.5	-10,308	-11,091	-2,335
Entries 13:00-23:00 only (London + New York)	-5,914	-4,772	-1,196
Entries 17:00-23:00 only (New York)	-3,352	-2,537	-123
Entries 06:00-17:00 only	-6,594	-7,395	-2,009
Minimum stop 4	-3,459	-3,752	-1,879
Minimum stop 6	-1,776	-2,021	-1,668
Minimum stop 8	-1,092	-474	-1,251
Pause after 2 losses in a row	-5,374	-5,193	-1,041
Pause after 3 losses in a row	-8,382	-6,838	-1,221
Longs only	-5,412	-4,376	-820
Shorts only	-4,534	-5,556	-1,313

Target R rows are estimated from each trade's best price (favourable excursion): a trade that reached the smaller target is counted as a win at that target.

The simulator and every setting you asked about

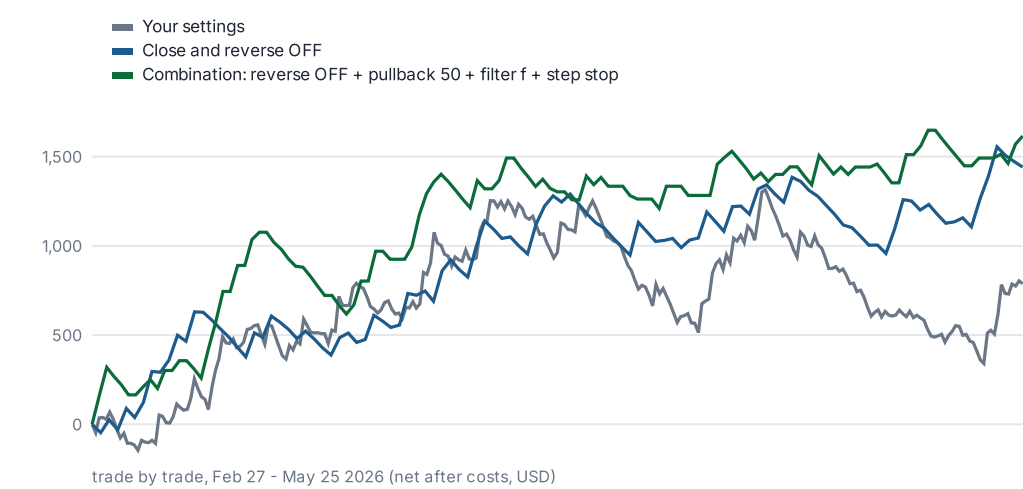
Real gold 1-minute data, your settings, one change at a time.

How it works. The strategy's structure engine (CHOCH / BOS, the 3-candle pullback, sweeps), the 15-minute trend for rule 2, the entry rules, the stop and target, the sizing with your costs, the session, 02:00 and weekend rules, and TradingView's way of filling orders inside a candle were written again in Python and run on real gold 1-minute data (Feb 25 - May 26 2026, 86,839 candles).

Checked against your own file. For that period your 2025-26 file has about 265 trades. 187 of them start in the same minute on the same side in the simulator (181 also with the same size), and those 187 trades net **1,081** in the simulator against **1,077** in your file. The others differ because this data is not OANDA's feed (prices are 0.3 to 0.6 apart). Totals: simulator **+789**, your file for the same days **+812**.

Settings that already exist

Test (one change at a time)	Trades	Net	PF	Max DD	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3
Your settings (v8.3: CHOCH only, R 3, pullback 25, stop buffer 1)	264	+789	1.15	975	+528	+93	+168
Close-and-reverse OFF	109	+1,442	1.52	427	+523	+519	+399
Target R 2 instead of 3	265	+890	1.18	959	+711	+159	+20
London + New York: entries 13:00-23:00	150	+678	1.26	287	-54	+299	+433
New York only: entries 17:00-23:00	90	+934	1.76	195	+337	+348	+249
Rule 2 only (higher timeframe must agree)	125	+59	1.02	821	+234	+150	-325
CHOCH and BOS, max 2 trades open	513	-267	0.98	2,075	+796	-972	-91
CHOCH and BOS, max 3 trades open	618	-1,100	0.92	3,049	+817	-1,374	-543
Break-even at 1R (group 32)	264	+794	1.17	836	+499	+90	+204
Step stop (group 32)	264	+1,025	1.22	837	+615	+181	+229
Minimum stop distance 6	254	+1,030	1.22	794	+528	+298	+203
Your settings with costs 0.3 per ounce instead of 0.6	264	+1,035	1.20	920	+653	+119	+263



PART 3

The seven new ideas

Each built into the simulator exactly as in v9.0, then switched on alone.

Test (one change at a time)	Trades	Net	PF	Max DD	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3
Your settings (v8.3: CHOCH only, R 3, pullback 25, stop buffer 1)	264	+789	1.15	975	+528	+93	+168
a. Stacked BOS trades at 50% risk (CHOCH and BOS, max 3)	593	-355	0.97	1,798	+633	-1,047	+59
CHOCH and BOS, max 3 trades open	618	-1,100	0.92	3,049	+817	-1,374	-543
b. Higher-timeframe filter (rule 1 in the HTF direction)	130	-86	0.97	742	+212	-46	-252
c. Trailing stop behind the CHOCH* level	264	+782	1.16	946	+573	+8	+201
c. Trailing stop behind every new swing	265	-129	0.96	663	+136	-245	-19
d. Target at the next liquidity, at least 1.5R	265	+1,024	1.21	890	+793	+273	-41
e. Partial profit: 50% at 1R, rest to break-even	468	+816	1.18	815	+482	+318	+16
f. Premium / discount filter with pullback 25 (yours)	1	-53	0.00	53	+0	-53	+0
f. Premium / discount filter 50 + pullback 50	142	+1,641	1.46	570	+850	+639	+151
(pullback 50 alone, no filter)	265	+1,707	1.29	1,238	+1,118	+850	-262
g. Pause for the day after 3 losses in a row	209	+762	1.19	805	+476	+242	+44
Hedge: LONG copy + SHORT copy, reverse OFF	185	+693	1.13	727	+214	+464	+16
COMBINATION: reverse OFF + pullback 50 + filter f + step stop	128	+1,616	1.68	458	+665	+617	+333
COMBINATION above + New York hours 17-23	43	+1,190	2.64	171	+388	+335	+467

Idea	Verdict	Why
a. Smaller risk for stacked BOS	WORSE	Stacking losses; smaller stacks only lose less. Keep CHOCH only.
b. Higher-timeframe filter	WORSE	The 15-minute trend was a poor guide on 1-minute gold.
c. Trailing - CHOCH* level	SAME	About the same result; worth a test on your chart.
c. Trailing - every swing	WORSE	Too tight: normal 1-minute noise stops the trade.
d. Target at next liquidity	SMALL GAIN	Better in 2 of 3 months at 1.5 R; worse at 1 R and 2 R.
e. Partial profit	SAME	Smoother, not more profitable. Often too small to split on gold.
f. Premium / discount	BETTER	Only with a 50% pullback: half the drawdown of pullback 50 alone.
g. Pause after losses	SAME	Loses less only by trading less.
Hedge (two copies)	SAME	About the same as one copy; one copy with reverse OFF did better.

The combination

Close and reverse OFF + rule 1 pullback 50 + premium / discount filter 50 + step stop made **+1,616** with profit factor 1.68 and a maximum drawdown of 458, better than your settings in all three months. Adding New York hours (entries from 17:00) kept **+1,190** with only 43 trades. These combinations were chosen after seeing the results, so they will look better here than they will be in the future - backtest them on a full year on your chart.

How to test it yourself

So the backtest does not fool you.

1. Change **one** setting at a time and write down trades, net profit, profit factor and max drawdown.
2. Use a full year. Then check the same settings on a **different** year without changing anything. Keep a change only if it is better in both.
3. Type your **real** costs: commission per lot and spread (group 23 and 26), and the Properties commission.
4. Use Bar Magnifier if your TradingView plan has it.
5. Run it on a demo account for two weeks and compare the demo trades with the backtest every week.